

Move to Columbus — Settling Pack

For people relocating to Columbus / Franklin County (and close suburbs). Print the PDF. Track the live numbers in the spreadsheet. Ignore fluff.

What’s in this pack

File	Use it for
This PDF	Readable checklists and guidance
Move-to-Columbus-Settling-Spreadsheet.xlsx	Fillable trackers with auto-totals

Spreadsheet tabs

1. **Start Here** — your move details
2. **Pre-Move** — checklist with done/remaining counts
3. **Neighborhood Score** — score 1–5 across 3 areas (totals + winner)
4. **Week 1 Setup** — utilities, address changes, local finds
5. **Month 1 Budget** — planned vs actual with variance
6. **Apartment Compare** — true monthly cost (rent + fees + utilities + commute)
7. **Day 30 Check-In** — settled score
8. **Local Rolodex** — pharmacy, grocery, urgent care, etc.

Yellow cells = your inputs. Green cells = calculated.

Pre-move (2–4 weeks out)

- ☐ Confirm lease/start date and utility transfer windows
- ☐ Photo-document empty place condition on move-in day
- ☐ Set mail forwarding
- ☐ Get quotes: movers vs truck+friends
- ☐ Measure elevator / stair constraints
- ☐ Plan first-night kit (sheets, towels, toilet paper, charger, meds, snacks)
- ☐ Download: ParkColumbus (if relevant), COTA, weather, maps offline area

Neighborhood fit scorecard

Score 1–5. Total helps you compare 2–3 areas.

Factor	Area A __	Area B __	Area C __
Commute to work			
Groceries walk/drive			
Noise tolerance fit			
Parking reality			
Weekend stuff nearby			

Budget fit (rent+fees)			
Total			

Common comparison set: Short North / Italian Village · German Village / Brewery · Clintonville · Grandview · Reynoldsburg / East side · Dublin / New Albany · Westerville · Grove City.

Week 1 setup

- ☐ Electric / gas / water / trash accounted for
- ☐ Internet installed or hotspot backup
- ☐ Renter's insurance binder saved offline
- ☐ Change address: bank, insurance, employer HR, subscriptions
- ☐ Ohio DL / ID update plan (if relocating from out of state)
- ☐ Vehicle registration / parking permit research for your street
- ☐ Find: pharmacy, urgent care, grocery, hardware
- ☐ Test smoke/CO detectors; buy batteries if needed
- ☐ Meet one neighbor or building manager on purpose

Local systems cheat sheet

Need	Where to start
City info / services	Columbus.gov
Income tax (city)	Confirm RITA / city withholding with employer payroll
Transit	COTA routes near home + work
Airport runs	CMH timing vs rideshare vs parking
Recycling rules	Your hauler's accepted list (don't assume)
Voter registration / records	Franklin County sites as needed

First-month budget worksheet

Category	Planned \$	Actual \$
Rent + fees		
Utilities		
Internet		
Groceries		
Transport / gas / rideshare		
Household setup buys		
Eating out		

Misc buffer		
Total		

Rule of thumb for month one: expect setup buys to overrun — protect the buffer line.

Day 30 check-in

- ☐ Emergency contacts on fridge / phone favorites
- ☐ Primary care / dentist search started
- ☐ One “regular” coffee or grocery routine established
- ☐ Know your street’s overnight parking / snow rules
- ☐ Have a severe weather plan (basement / interior room)
- ☐ Social: one recurring local activity on calendar (league, meetup, class, faith, hobby)

Packing priority for Columbus seasons

Bring sooner than you think:

- ☐ Solid rain jacket
- ☐ Ice scraper if you have a car
- ☐ Door mat (salt / mud season)
- ☐ Window covers for summer heat

Done looks like

You can answer: where you buy food, how you get to work, what happens in a storm, and who you’d text locally if something breaks.

Buckeye Trail Guide · Curated by Keith Householder · Columbus, Ohio

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